The free plastic swap list

Six swaps my family made between August 2024 and September 2025, room by room, with what each one replaced and what we paid.

Kitchen

Cutting board

Plastic to bamboo

Every cut scrapes the board. On a plastic board, those scrapes are tiny pieces of plastic, and some of them end up in the food.

What we bought	Allsum bamboo cutting board
What we paid	$14.97
When	August 2024

Kitchen

Spatula

Plastic to stainless steel

Plastic and nylon spatulas wear down against hot pans. Stainless steel holds up to the heat.

What we bought	Zulay stainless steel spatula
What we paid	$12.99
When	November 2024

Kitchen

Food storage

Plastic to glass

Heat and scrubbing wear down plastic food containers over time. Glass holds leftovers just as well. The lids on ours are still plastic, so leave the lid off when you heat food.

What we bought	Rubbermaid Brilliance glass containers, set of 9
What we paid	$79.99
When	October 2024

Dishes

Dishwasher detergent

Pods to plastic-free tablets

Many dishwasher pods are wrapped in a film of polyvinyl alcohol, a plastic made to dissolve in water. Plain tablets have no film at all.

What we bought	Wild Clean unscented tablets, then Blueland plastic-free tablets
What we paid	$19.99 a month; $23.99
When	April 2025; September 2025

Bathroom

Toothbrush

Plastic to bamboo and boar bristle

A standard toothbrush has a plastic handle and nylon bristles. Ours have bamboo handles and natural boar bristles.

What we bought	Primals boar bristle and bamboo toothbrushes
What we paid	$27.99 a pack
When	July 2025

Closet

Underwear

Synthetic to cotton

Polyester and nylon are plastics, and clothes made from them shed tiny fibers. Cotton is a natural fiber.

What we bought	Amazon Essentials cotton boxer briefs, pack of 5
What we paid	$18.00
When	December 2024